

iPhone when it comes out, it is time to start tagging that cluttered library properly along with the album art. It will be worth it. The Previous, Play/Pause and Next buttons are at the bottom of the display followed by the volume control bar. For some reason, there seems to be no indication of the length of the track or the current playback position on this screen. This is quite odd, and we can only hope that they include those in the final shipping version. When you flip the album art around, you can see all the tracks in the current album complete with the track number and duration for each. At the top of the screen, there is a provision for rating the currently playing album on a scale of five stars, like in iTunes.

Now comes the most interesting part: you can simply turn the phone around and hold it horizontally while the iPod is running. The phone senses the change in orientation, automatically switches to landscape mode, and displays Cover Flow. Here you can simply browse through the covers using the flicking gesture with your finger and tap on any cover to have it flip around and display the list of songs in the album. This is an added functionality, lacking in iTunes, and it makes Cover Flow very useful. Click on any song to start the playback. At the bottom left-hand corner of the Cover Flow screen is the Play/Pause button, and there is an “Info” button at the right-hand corner which, according to our presumptions, will show you all the relevant information about either the currently playing album/track or of the album which is at the forefront in the Cover Flow navigation. After you’re done, simply rotating the phone back to its upright state brings you to the currently playing screen described above.

Of course, as with the iPod, you can make any number of playlists and play them conveniently. The “More” tab houses six other options—Albums, Audiobooks, Compilations, Composers, Games, and Podcasts. Selecting the “Albums” option lists all the albums stored on the phone in a list with a small thumbnail of the album art and the title of the each album. All the other options are pretty self-explanatory. The presence of the “Games” option